Little Fox Readers

Level 5

Journey to the West 50
Magic Fire



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Little Fox

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Magic Fire



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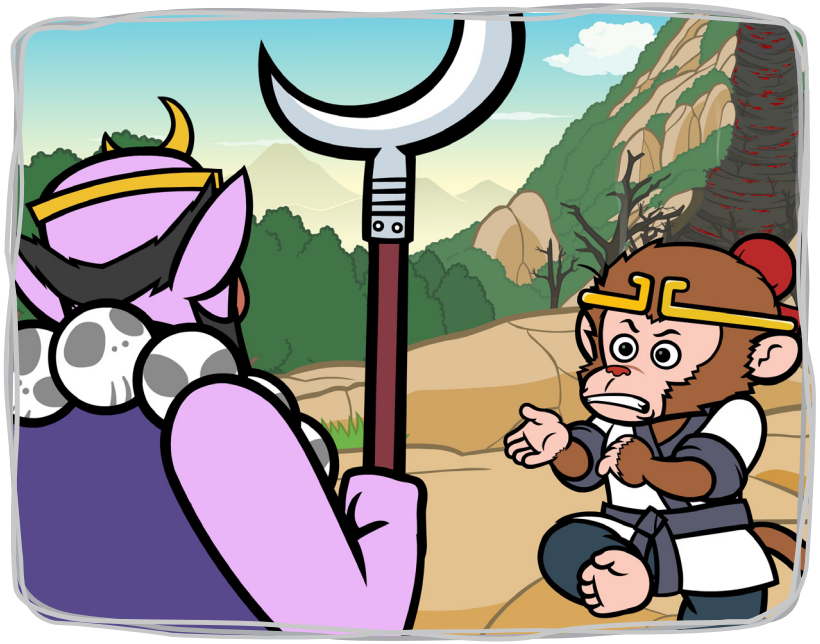
Wukong and his companions ran back down the mountain, escaping the fire.

"Red Boy's fire is powerful," said the monkey.

"We were nearly roasted!" said Bajie.

Wujing looked up at the mountain peak. "The fire is dying down now."

"Yes," said Wukong, looking at the last few wisps of smoke. "But he'll use it again if



we go back up there."

"We need water," said Wujing. "Then if he makes fire again, we can just put it out."

Wukong nodded. "You two wait here. I know who can help us."

The monkey shot into the air and flew away. When he returned, the Dragon King of the Eastern Sea was with him. Wukong introduced the Dragon King to Bajie and



Wujing.

"I can summon rain clouds," said the Dragon King. "Go back up the mountain, and get Red Boy to come out. As soon as he makes his fire, I'll create a huge rainstorm."

The Dragon King flew up into the sky. Wukong and the others returned to the cave.

"Open up, Red Boy!" The monkey pounded on the cave door.



The door flew open and Red Boy ran outside.

"Release the Tang Monk right now!" shouted Wukong.

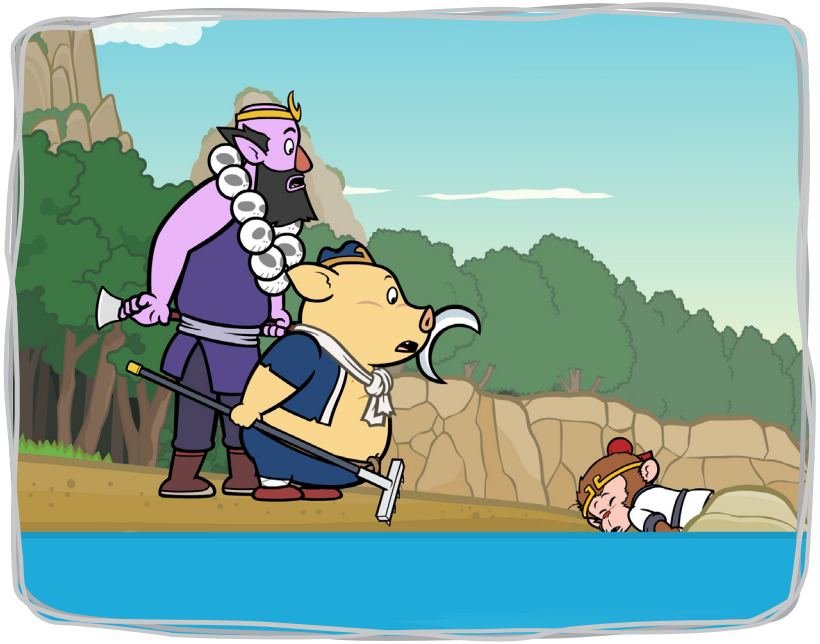
"Never!" shouted the demon. He made a fist and punched himself in the nose. Smoke and fire poured from his face again.

"Dragon King!" called the monkey. "Make it rain!"



Thunder rumbled as dark clouds filled the sky. Rain poured down. The fire, however, didn't go out. Instead it grew—bigger and bigger. The smoke became thick.

Coughing and unable to breathe, Wukong covered his face. He saw Bajie and Wujing running away. The monkey tried to get to the cave door, but the smoke was too thick. He tripped on a rock and tumbled down the side



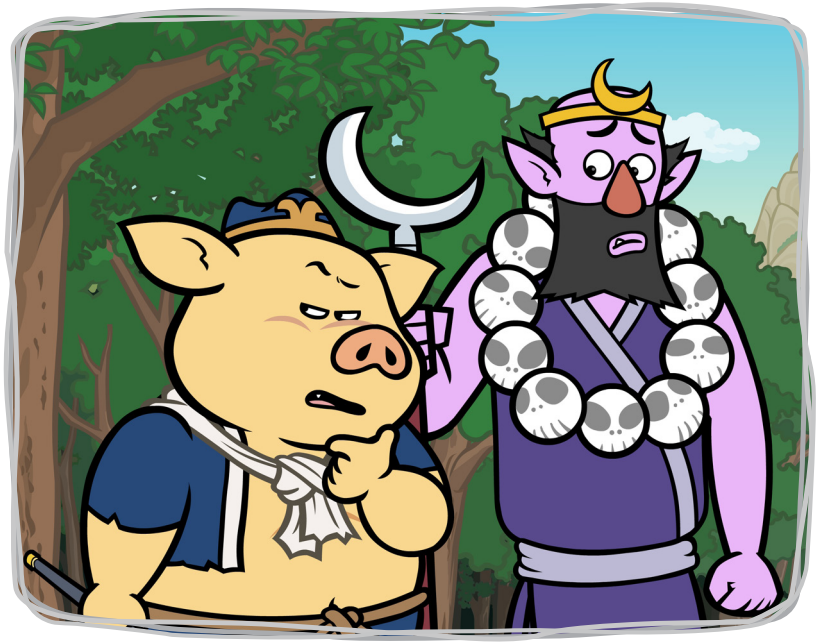
of the mountain.

Splash! Wukong landed in a river and floated downstream. Finally he washed up on the riverbank, coughing and wheezing.

Bajie and Wujing rushed over to the monkey.

"Wukong, are you all right?" asked Wujing.

"I think so," said the monkey. He coughed

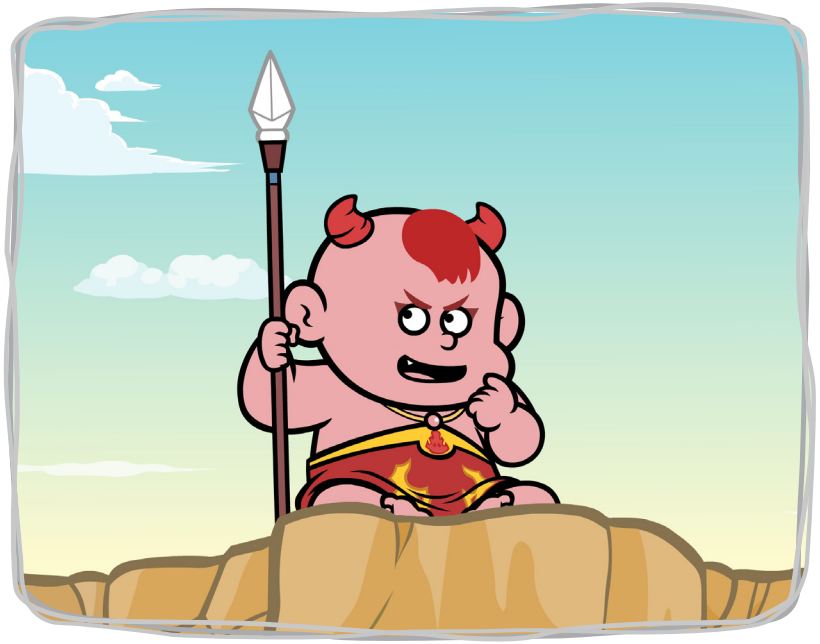


again. “That fire is no ordinary fire. The water made it worse.”

“You’re right,” said the pig. “It must be magic fire. What will we do now? Red Boy still has the Tang Monk in his cave.”

“I’ll ask Guanyin for help,” said Wukong, standing up.

“You rest,” said Bajie. “You breathed in a lot of smoke. I’ll go to Guanyin.”

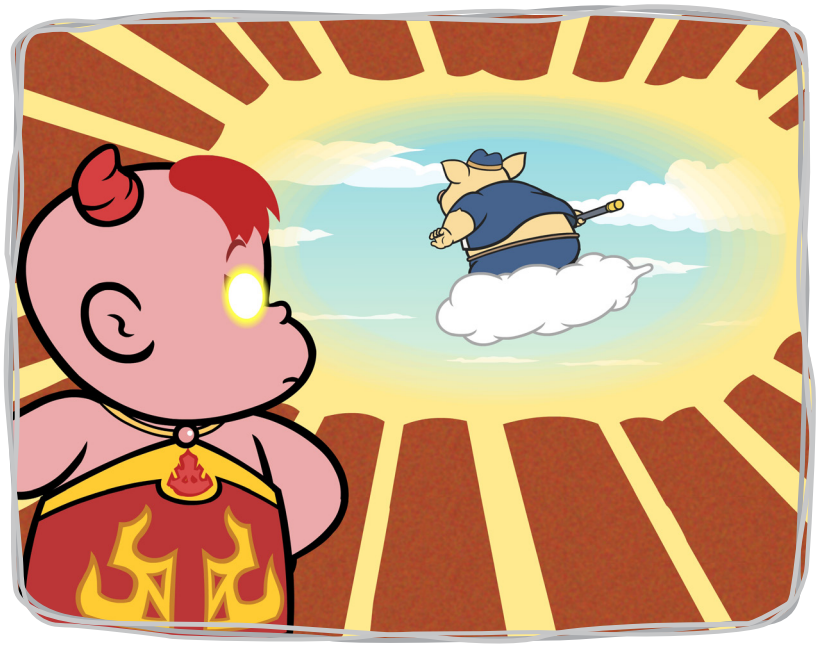


The monkey coughed again. “Okay, Bajie. But go straight to Guanyin. No naps!”

Meanwhile Red Boy was sitting on his mountain peak.

“My fire was too powerful for Sun Wukong and his friends,” he said to himself. “They must be dead now.”

The demon patted his belly. “And that is good because I am hungry. I’ll go inside now



and start cooking the Tang Monk."

The demon stood up to leave when he spotted something in the sky.

"It's the pig!" he said. "He's heading south. I wonder why." Red Boy thought for a minute. "Aha! The bodhisattva Guanyin lives on Mount Potalaka, in the South Sea. The pig must be going to ask her for help. I'll stop him!"



The demon recited a quick spell, and light sparkled around him. Now Red Boy looked exactly like Guanyin.

Bajie soared through the sky on his cloud. He saw Guanyin coming toward him.

"Bodhisattva!" cried the pig with a smile. "This is a surprise. I was just coming to see you!"